

Diploma in

PHOTOSHOP



SUMMARY NOTES

Enhancing Images
Lesson 2

THIS IS AN EXPLORATION OF THE CORE ADJUSTMENT OPTIONS OFFERED BY PHOTOSHOP AND WILL GIVE YOU AN INSIGHT INTO HOW EACH ONE WORKS, AND WHEN AND WHERE TO APPLY THEM. A FIRM UNDERSTANDING OF HOW THESE STRONG ADJUSTMENTS WORK, WILL ALLOW YOU TO ENHANCE YOUR IMAGES AND GIVE THEM A NEW CREATIVE EDGE AS WELL AS CREATING SOME TRULY UNIQUE ARTWORK!

2.01**The Pixel**

2.02**Adjustments**

2.03**Tonal & Colour**

LESSON 2

THE PIXEL

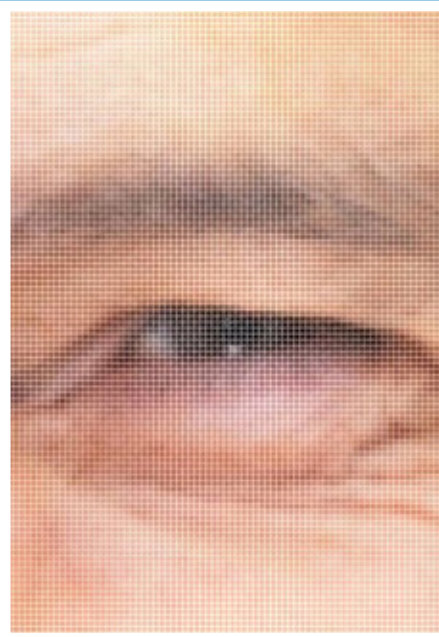
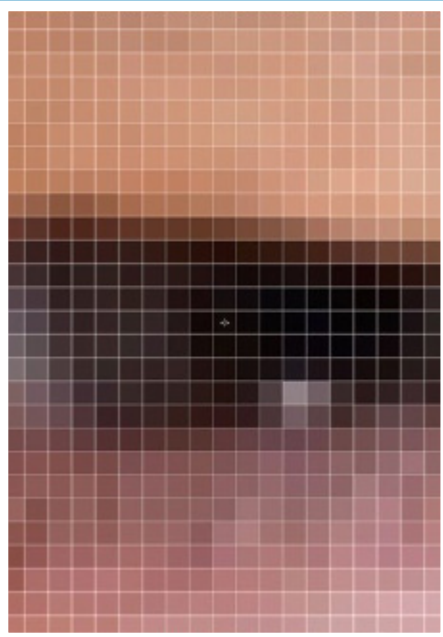
“When we have lots and lots of pixels they seem to visually dissolve into what we refer to as a “continuous tone image”

When we're using Photoshop, it's really important to know the fundamentals of digital imagery! To understand digital imagery, we have to understand it's most basic building blocks – the Pixel.

The Pixel is short for Picture Element. Pixels are the building blocks of an image. They are tiny, single coloured squares that are arranged like mosaic tiles, in horizontal and vertical lines to form a an image. If you open an image in Photoshop and continue to zoom into it beyond 100%, you will start seeing the pixels which the image is made of.

A pixel is a single dot of colour, and is always a perfect square. It can only ever be square and only ever be one colour. Our images are made up of thousands and thousands of these pixels. Each pixel aligns to the pixel next to it in rows and columns with no gaps in between. When we have lots and lots of pixels they seem to visually dissolve into what we refer to as a “continuous tone image” - photographs are continuous tone images!

All of our photographs are made up of similarly coloured pixels that have merged in our brains to represent details that don't look square at all! In fact, having thousands and millions of these different coloured pixels allow us to have full coloured images!



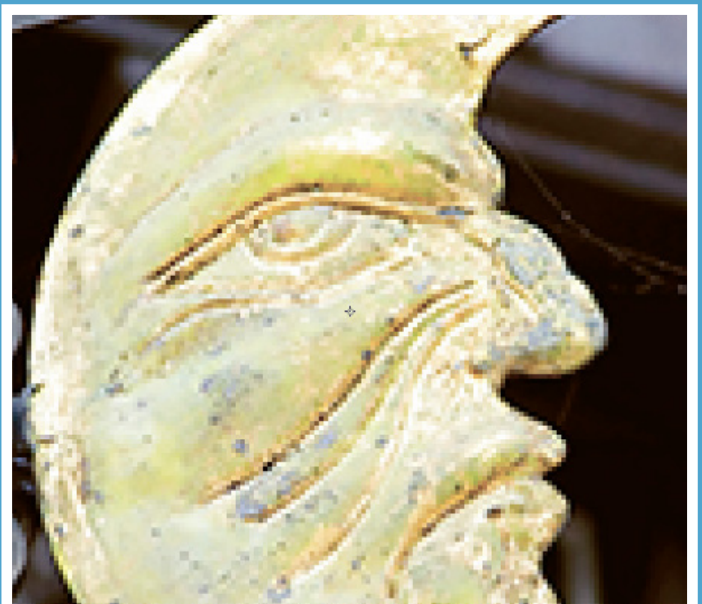
Resolution refers to how images are resolved to your eye where you can see it clearly as an image with smooth lines and lots of detail, or an image that we can see the individual building blocks. Resolution also refers to the pixel count within the image and how many pixels are there.

High Resolution

A high resolution image and it has loads and loads of pixels. All lines seem smooth and we have lots of detail, texture, sharpness and tone. If we zoom right into a high resolution image, we cannot identify individual pixels and we still see all the lines and shapes as smooth. More levels of magnification are needed to see the pixels.

Low Resolution

Just the opposite of high resolution. You will not have to zoom in too much to see the individual pixels. Just a little bit of zooming and you will start to see pixelation in the image. If there is a very small amount of pixels you will be able to identify the building blocks of the image by eye, and it will not resolve to your well to your eye. When we zoom in here we can see very jagged lines. The jagged lines that you can see are the edges of individual squares that are forming the shapes and lines.



ADJUSTMENTS

Adjustments are used to enhance your images and photographs. They have many uses and can be used for big and small enhancements. Each Adjustment comes with options to alter the amount of the effect and other capabilities. Adjustments can be applied destructively to one image. This option is when we directly apply an adjustment to an image. It changes the image directly, altering the pixels of the image. These adjustments are permanent unless undone or stepped back. Adjustments can also be applied non-destructively as an Adjustment layer. This option allows the adjustment to be toggled on and off. This method of adjustments does not effect the pixel directly and also comes with a mask attached. Adjustments can be broke be broke down into different categories with the focus on Tonal and Colour Adjustments.

Tonal Adjustments

- Brightness & Contrast
- Levels
- Curves
- Exposure

Colour Adjustments

- Vibrance
- Hue/Saturation
- Colour Balance
- Black & White
- Photo Mixer
- Channel Mixer
- Colour Lookup

Other Adjustments

- Invert
- Posterize
- Threshold
- Selective Colour
- Gradient



TONAL & COLOUR

Tonal Adjustments effect the shadows, mid-tones and highlights of an image. These adjustments can be applied to black and white and coloured images.

These adjustments also have an Auto option. Tonal adjustments can be made with different adjustments each one having a different way to make the adjustments, a more in-depth adjustment or a more effective adjustment. The main Adjustments in this category are:

- Brightness & Contrast
- Levels
- Curves

Brightness & Contrast

Brightness

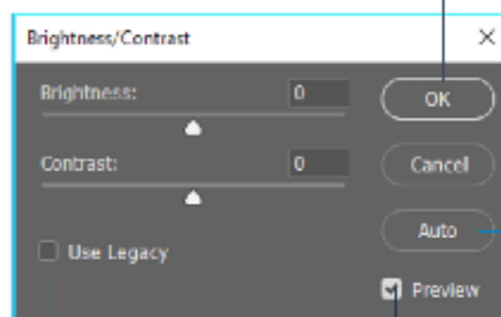
This refers to the overall lightness or darkness. We will change entire image pixels

Contrast

This refers to the difference in brightness between objects in the image

Legacy

This option refers to images edited in older versions of photoshop. Can still be used if you prefer



OK/Cancel

- Accept or Cancel adjustments made

Auto

Allow Photoshop to make Adjustments for you

Preview

- Allow the image to be edited in real-time so we can preview our enhancements

Enhancing Images

Levels

Preset

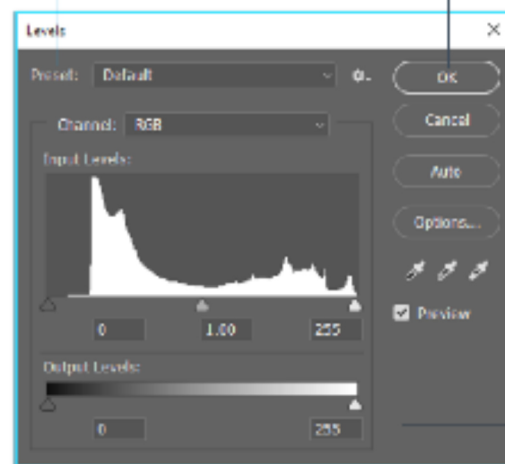
- Default tonal adjustments built in. You can also create custom sets

Histogram

- The histogram shows data in the shadows, mid tones and highlights. We edit our image based on this data

Output

- This option can set a minimum Black and maximum White in an image



OK/Cancel

- Accept or Cancel adjustments made

Auto

- Allow Photoshop to make Adjustments for you

Droppers

- Eye Dropper tools to set a Black, Gray and White point.

Preview

- Allow the image to be edited in real-time so we can preview our enhancements

Curves

Preset

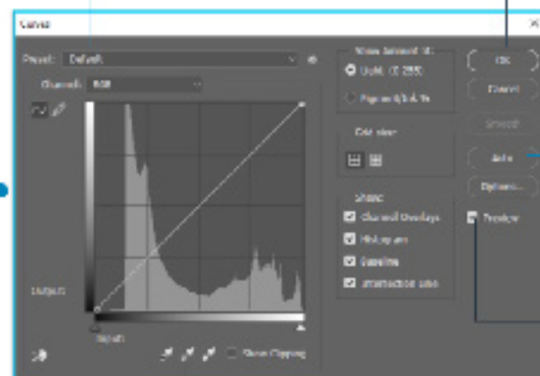
- Default tonal adjustments built in. You can also create custom sets

Histogram

- The histogram shows data in the shadows, mid tones and highlights. We edit our image based on this data

Hand Icon

- This will allow you to choose a specific part of the image to set a value



OK/Cancel

- Accept or Cancel adjustments made

Auto

- Allow Photoshop to make Adjustments for you

Preview

- Allow the image to be edited in real-time so we can preview our enhancements

Droppers

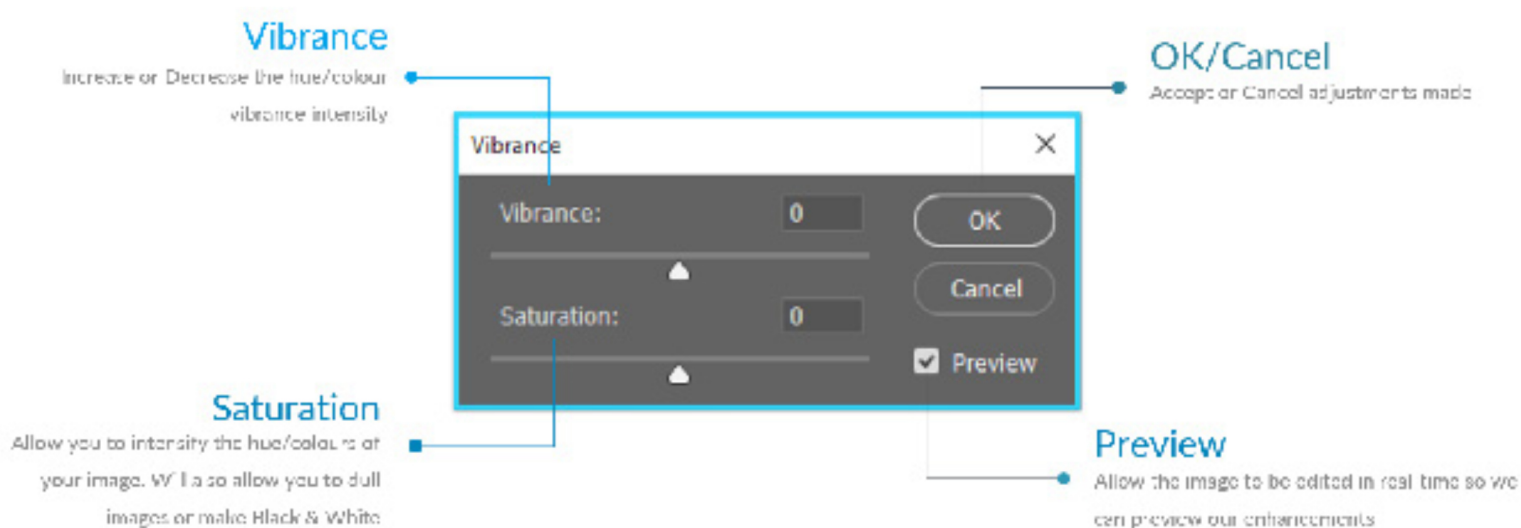
- Eye Dropper tools to set a Black, Gray and White point

Colour Adjustments effect the Hue, Saturation and Brightness of your images. These adjustments can be applied alter, enhance or completely change your coloured images. Much like our Tonal Adjustments, Colour Adjustments will effect black and white images too. Most of these adjustments also have an Auto option for quick changes.

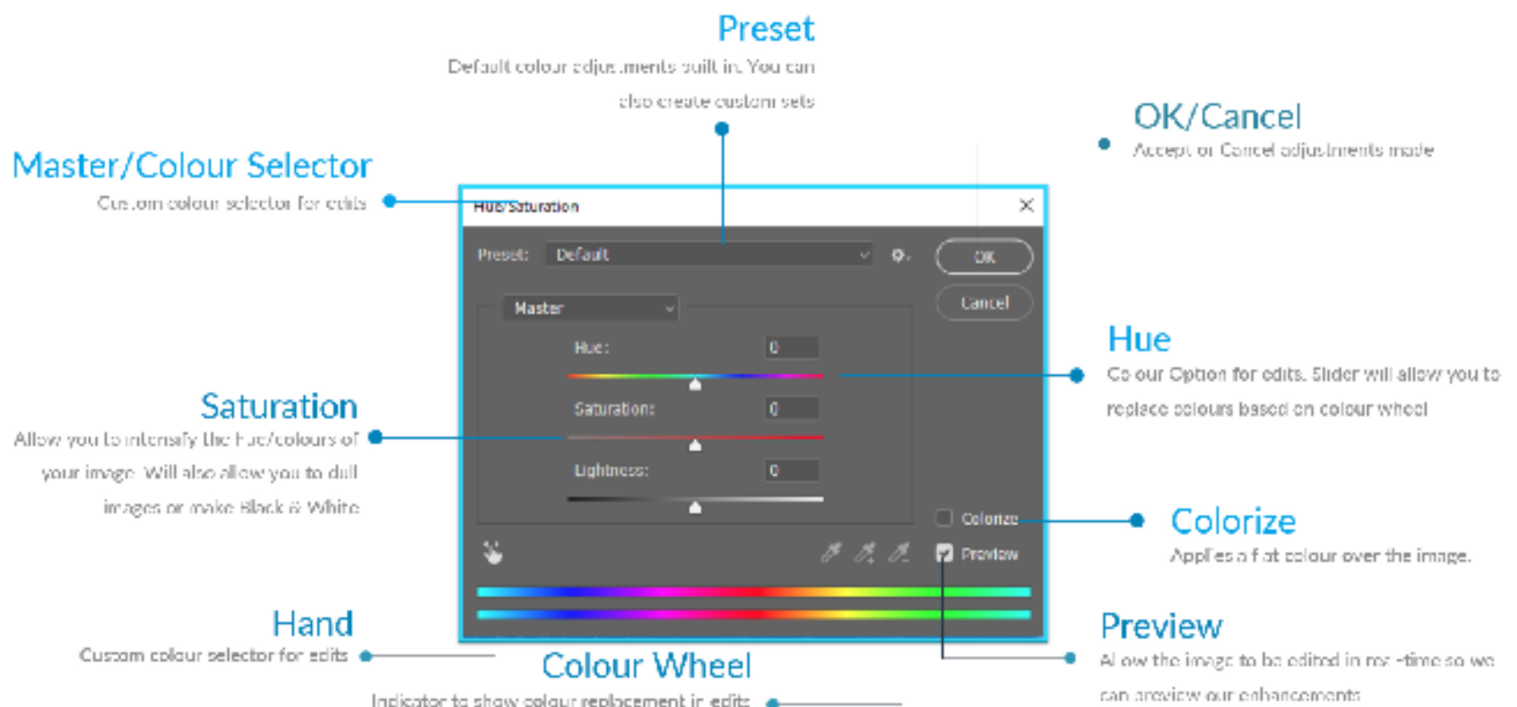
Colour adjustments will do exactly what you guess, adjust colour in an image. We can saturated colours, tone them down and even change colours altogether. The main Adjustments in this category are:

- Vibrance
- Hue & Saturation

Vibrance



Hue & Saturation







THANK YOU